



Milena Vásquez-Amézquita

ASSOCIATE PROFESSOR

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📧 Milena-Vasquez-Amezquita | 🏠 grupo-codec.netlify.app/author/milena-vasquez-amezquita/

I am a researcher primarily interested in the neurocognitive bases of human affect and sexuality.

About me

Psychologist, MSc in Basic and Applied Neurosciences, and PhD in Neurosciences. I am a researcher in cognitive neuroscience applied to human sexual behavior. My research integrates cognitive neuroscience, evolutionary psychology, and public health to understand how the brain processes sexually relevant information and how these mechanisms shape sexual attraction, mate preferences, sexual response, and sexual behavior. Using experimental methods—particularly eye tracking—I investigate both normative and atypical sexual interests, with the goal of advancing basic science and informing evidence-based strategies for the prevention of child sexual abuse and exploitation.

I am an Associate Professor at the [Faculty of Psychology](#) at [Universidad El Bosque](#) and an active associate researcher within the [CODEC: Cognitive and Behavioural Sciences](#) Research Group (classified **A1** by MinCiencias). I lead the [SexCog: Sexuality and Affectivity from a Neurocognitive Perspective](#) research hotbed and have led and co-led internally and externally funded research projects using experimental approaches in cognitive neuroscience. I completed a postdoctoral fellowship at [Universidad de la Costa](#), funded by [MinCiencias](#).

Over the past 15 years, I have combined research and university teaching, contributing to undergraduate and graduate education in the neurobiological and cognitive bases of human behavior while supervising undergraduate, master's, and doctoral research projects.



Skills

Programming	R (Basic, data analysis and graph generation)
Quantitative Research	Observational-correlational studies, Simple and Mixed general linear models
Recording techniques	Eye tracking (mainly), other basic HRV, EEG
Software	RStudio, Tobii Pro Lab, Qualtrics, Psychomorph, WebmorphR, Mendeley and Zotero
Languages	English/Spanish (native)

Education

Universidad de Valencia

PHD - NEUROSCIENCES

Valencia, España

2018

Universidad de Valencia

MASTER'S DEGREE IN BASIC AND APPLIED NEUROSCIENCES

Valencia, España

2012

Universidad Católica de Colombia

PSYCHOLOGY

Bogotá, Colombia

2007

Research Experience

Universidad El Bosque

ASSOCIATE PROFESSOR

Bogotá, Colombia

Jan. 2020 - Present

Universidad de la Costa

VISITING PROFESSOR

Barranquilla, Colombia

Dec.2023 - Dec. 2024

Universidad Internacional de Valencia

COLLABORATING PROFESSOR

Valencia, España

Oct.2023 - Present

Professional Experience

For a full list, and a description of responsibilities, please check my [academic CV](#).

ONG RedPapaz

EXTERNAL SCIENTIFIC CONSULTANT

Bogotá, Colombia

Sep. - Oct. 2022

Protect Children

INTERNATIONAL SCIENTIFIC CONSULTANT

Helsinki, Finlandia

Jul. - Aug. 2021

Accomplishments

For information on **grants, scholarships, awards** and **prizes**, please check my [academic CV](#).

Selected Publications

6 *h-index* 19 *g-index* 5 *i10-index* 26 Publications 397 Citations

For a full list, please check the publications section on my [academic CV](#).

Castellanos-Chacón, A., Arias-Otero, D., Uribe-Jaramillo, V., Leongómez, J. D., & **Vásquez-Amézquita, M.** (2026). Effects of stimulus emotional content on gaze pattern: An eye-tracking study. *PLOS One*, 21(1), e0341261. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0341261>

Vásquez-Amézquita, M., Castellanos-Chacón, A., Medina-Sarmiento, W., Cepeda, V., Martínez-González, M. B., & Leongómez, J. D. (2025). Resource availability and experiences of partner violence shape facial masculinity preferences in Colombian women. *Evolution and Human Behavior*, 46(4), 106707. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.evolhumbehav.2025.106707>

Vásquez-Amézquita, M., Martínez-González, M. B., Chivers, M. L., & Leongómez, J. D. (2025). Does Trait Sexual Desire Predict Subjective Sexual Response to Erotic Stimuli? Effects of Participant Gender, Stimulus Gender, and Relationship Status Among Cisgender Heterosexual Women and Men. *Archives of Sexual Behavior*, 54, 4209–4223. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10508-025-03298-w>

Vásquez-Amézquita, M., Cepeda, V., Roa, E., Torres, J. S., Maldonado-Avenidaño, N., Martínez-González, M. B., & Leongómez, J. D. (2025). Sexual modes questionnaire (SMQ): Spanish translation, adaptation, and preliminary evidence of psychometric properties in a Colombian sample. *Sexual and Relationship Therapy*, 1–25. <https://doi.org/10.1080/14681994.2025.2507109>

Vásquez-Amézquita, M., Leongómez, J. D., Salvador, A., & Seto, M. C. (2023). What can the eyes tell us about atypical sexual preferences as a function of sex and age? Linking eye movements with child-related chronophilias. *Forensic Sciences Research*, 8(1)1–11. <https://doi.org/10.1093/fsr/owad009>

Vásquez-Amézquita, M., Salvador, A., & Leongómez, J. D. (2021). Existen diferencias en la ratio 2D:4D entre delinquentes sexuales y no sexuales, y hombres no delinquentes? Un estudio en una muestra colombiana. *Interdisciplinaria. Revista de Psicología y Ciencias Afines*, 39(1). <https://doi.org/10.16888/interd.2022.39.1.8>

Jones, B. C., DeBruine, L. M., Flake, J. K., Liuzza, M. T., Antfolk, J., Arinze, N. C., Ndukaihe, I. L. G., Bloxsom, N. G., Lewis, S. C., Foroni, F., Willis, M. L., Cubillas, C. P., Vadillo, M. A., Turiegano, E., Gilead, M., Simchon, A., Saribay, S. A., Owsley, N. C., Jang, C. ..., **Vásquez-Amézquita, M.**, ..., Coles, N. A. (2021). To which world regions does the valence–dominance model of social perception apply? *Nature Human Behaviour*, 5(1) 159–169. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-020-01007-2>

Vásquez-Amézquita, M., Leongómez, J. D., Seto, M. C., Bonilla, F. M., Rodríguez-Padilla, A., & Salvador, A. (2018). No relation between digit ratio (2D:4D) and visual attention patterns to sexually preferred and non-preferred stimuli. *Personality and Individual Differences*, 120, 151–158. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.paid.2017.08.022>

Vásquez-Amézquita, M., Leongómez, J. D., Seto, M. C., Bonilla, M., Rodríguez-Padilla, A., & Salvador, A. (2019). Visual Attention Patterns Differ in Gynephilic and Androphilic Men and Women Depending on Age and Gender

of Targets. *The Journal of Sex Research*, 56(1), 85–101. <https://doi.org/10.1080/00224499.2017.1372353>

Vásquez-Amézquita, M., Leongómez, J. D., Seto, M. C., & Salvador, A. (2019). Differences in Visual Attention Patterns to Sexually Mature and Immature Stimuli Between Heterosexual Sexual Offenders, Nonsexual Offenders, and Nonoffending Men. *The Journal of Sex Research*, 56 (2), 213–228. <https://doi.org/10.1080/00224499.2018.1511965>

Postgraduate Supervision

For a full list, including undergraduate supervision, please check my [academic CV](#).

Leidy Nathaly Peláez Bernal

MSC IN NEUROPSYCHOLOGY

*Universidad Internacional de
Valencia, España
2023-2024*

Jimena Zanizo Chambi

MSC IN NEUROPSYCHOLOGY

*Universidad Internacional de
Valencia, España
2023-2024*

Liceth Andrea Zaraza Osorio

MSC IN NEUROPSYCHOLOGY

*Universidad Internacional de
Valencia, España
2023-2024*